

(clockwise from top) A poster for Lionsgate Play's *Jugaadistan*; a still from Yadav's *Campus Diaries*; and a still from Netflix's *Mismatched*

noticed that creative heads at streaming platforms are now more receptive to his ideas. "Earlier they'd be like '*Log yeh nahin dekhenge* (People won't watch this), so include some older characters and give them



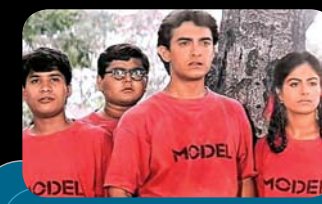
basic romantic tropes of the genre and "capture the zeitgeist of this generation", says Khanna. "It is only when you are young that you are fearless. You make decisions on the spur of the moment. It is a lovely spirit to catch," she adds. "We need to showcase characters who embody the diverse nature of people we meet in college. The people of this generation are very keen to identify who they are and are open about what they do. They want to answer the larger questions of life."

Yadav says he has also some importance'," he says. "I have had to insist that we don't need to. They now get what I am saying." This is also perhaps because numbers speak for themselves. After leaving TVF, Yadav created *Campus Diaries*, which garnered over a 100 million views within just two weeks of its release. Featuring Saloni Gaur a.k.a. digital creator Salonayyy, the 12-episode youth drama centres around five friends on campus. Unsurprisingly, Yadav, is already busy with developing season two. ■

–Suhani Singh

Schools that Rock

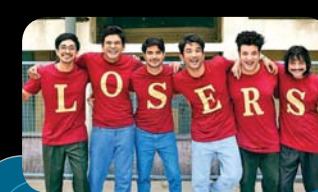
Three iconic young adult stories from past and present



Jo Jeeta Wohi Sikandar (1992/ Zee5)
It has been three decades since this film released, but the rivalry between privileged Rajput college brats and the relatively hard-up Model students still feels fresh



Rockford (1999/ Disney+ Hotstar)
Set in a boarding school, this coming-of-age drama offers a tender take on friendship, first crushes and student-teacher relationships



Chhichhore (2019/ Disney+ Hotstar)
Filmmaker Nitesh Tiwari revisited his IIT Bombay days to create this delightful college drama that emphasised the need to focus on one's efforts, not the result